

Identification
Screening
Eligibility
Included
Analysed

Articles retrieved from PubMed and Embase (n = 8712)



Articles screened after deduplication (n = 8219)



Full-text articles assessed for eligibility (n = 198)



Articles excluded (n = 153):

- Not primary trial report (n = 103)
- Not the ALSFRS-R as primary outcome (n = 15)
- Not randomised or deviating trial design (n = 11)
- Enrolment starting before 1999 (n = 6)
- Not a disease-modifying intervention (n = 6)
- Incomplete/inaccessible (n = 4)
- Follow-up period < 12 weeks (n = 2)
- Phase I trial (n = 2)
- Less than 20 patients randomised (n = 1)
- No results yet (n = 1)
- No description of statistical analysis (n = 1)
- Not in ALS (n = 1)



Articles included in review (n = 45)



Statistical analyses excluded (n = 9):

- Analyses merged due to similarity (n = 6)
- Unavailability of lead-in phase in data (n = 3)



Statistical methods included in analysis (n = 36)